

MODULE

3

Let Freedom Ring!

*"I love to see the starry flag
That floats above my head.
I love to see its wavering folds
With stripes of white and red."*

— FROM "OUR FLAG" (ANONYMOUS)

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do historic places, documents, and symbols represent the United States?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1 **The U.S. Constitution** · Norman Pearl

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

2 **Why We Celebrate the Fourth of July** · Informational Video

MEDIA

3 **The Flag Maker** · Susan Campbell Bartoletti

NARRATIVE NONFICTION

4 **Why Is the Statue of Liberty Green?** · Martha E. H. Rustad

NARRATIVE NONFICTION

CONTENTS

A · Vocabulary (21)	p. 2
B · Reading Comprehension (32)	p. 6
C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 14
D · MAP Practice (20)	p. 17

NAME _____

DATE _____



Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 3 · Let Freedom Ring! · Grade 3 · 21 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

loyal

When you are **loyal** to someone or something, you —

- ☐ **A.** forget about it quickly.
- ☐ **B.** argue against it all the time.
- ☐ **C.** strongly support it and stay true to it.
- ☐ **D.** keep it a secret from everyone.

Q2 L.3.6

sovereignty

Sovereignty is —

- ☐ **A.** the right and power a nation has to rule itself.
- ☐ **B.** a building where laws are kept.
- ☐ **C.** a kind of song sung at a parade.
- ☐ **D.** a holiday in the middle of summer.

Q3 L.3.6

democracy

A **democracy** is —

- ☐ **A.** a written list of famous names.
- ☐ **B.** a country ruled by one king alone.
- ☐ **C.** a tall building in a capital city.
- ☐ **D.** a kind of government in which the people choose leaders by voting.

Q4 L.3.6

civic

The word **civic** describes —

- ☐ **A.** the weather in a faraway place.
- ☐ **B.** the duties, rights, and responsibilities of citizens.
- ☐ **C.** a kind of music from long ago.
- ☐ **D.** the colors used on a flag.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE U.S. CONSTITUTION

Q5 L.3.4

convention

The delegates met at a **convention** in Philadelphia. A **convention** is —

- ☐ **A.** a meeting of people who share the same purpose or ideas.
- ☐ **B.** a long road between two cities.
- ☐ **C.** a set of rules for a game.
- ☐ **D.** a holiday that happens once a year.

Q6 L.3.4

delegates

Each state sent **delegates** to the meeting. **Delegates** are —

- ☐ **A.** soldiers who guard a fort.
- ☐ **B.** books that list every law.
- ☐ **C.** people chosen to make decisions for a larger group.
- ☐ **D.** flags flown over a building.

Q7 L.3.5

TRAP

domestic

The Constitution promises "**domestic** tranquility," or peace at home. When something is **domestic**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** a tame animal kept as a pet.
- ☐ **B.** a part of, or about, the country you live in.
- ☐ **C.** a chore done around the house.
- ☐ **D.** a journey to a faraway land.

Q8 L.3.4

welfare

If someone looks out for your **welfare**, that person —

- ☐ **A.** takes away the things you own.
- ☐ **B.** tells you to be quiet.
- ☐ **C.** writes down everything you say.
- ☐ **D.** makes sure you are healthy and happy.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE U.S. CONSTITUTION (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.4

posterity

When you think about **posterity**, you are thinking about —

- ☐ **A.** a poster hung on a wall.
- ☐ **B.** the mail that came in the morning.
- ☐ **C.** all the people who will be alive in the future.
- ☐ **D.** the back door of a house.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WHY WE CELEBRATE THE FOURTH OF JULY

Q10 L.3.4

independence

The colonies wanted their **independence**. When you have **independence**, you —

- ☐ **A.** are free to set your own rules and make your own choices.
- ☐ **B.** must follow another country's orders.
- ☐ **C.** have to share everything you own.
- ☐ **D.** live far away from other people.

Q11 L.3.4

declaring

When you are **declaring** something, you —

- ☐ **A.** are quietly hiding it from others.
- ☐ **B.** are slowly forgetting it.
- ☐ **C.** are asking a question about it.
- ☐ **D.** feel strongly about it and are making it clearly known.

Q12 L.3.5 TRAP

endowed

The Declaration says people are **endowed** with certain rights. If you are **endowed** with a quality, it —

- ☐ **A.** is at the very end of a line.
- ☐ **B.** is yours and belongs to you.
- ☐ **C.** is borrowed for only one day.
- ☐ **D.** has just been taken from you.

Q13 L.3.5 TRAP

presented

The leaders **presented** the new document to the people. If you **presented** something, you —

- ☐ **A.** showed it or gave it to someone.
- ☐ **B.** wrapped it as a birthday gift.
- ☐ **C.** were there at this very moment.
- ☐ **D.** pressed it down very hard.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE FLAG MAKER

Q14 L.3.4

broad

They cut **broad** red and white stripes for the flag. Something that is **broad** is —

- ☐ **A.** short and pointed.
- ☐ **B.** soft and warm.
- ☐ **C.** wide.
- ☐ **D.** bright and shiny.

Q15 L.3.4

gritty

Caroline's hands felt **gritty** from the hard work. Something **gritty** is —

- ☐ **A.** smooth and slippery.
- ☐ **B.** wet and cold.
- ☐ **C.** sweet to the taste.
- ☐ **D.** rough, as if covered with sand or grit.

Q16 L.3.4

hoisted

The soldiers **hoisted** the huge flag over the fort. If you **hoisted** a flag, you —

- ☐ **A.** folded it and put it away.
- ☐ **B.** used ropes to pull it up a pole.
- ☐ **C.** tore it into pieces.
- ☐ **D.** sewed it back together.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WHY IS THE STATUE OF LIBERTY GREEN?

Q17 L.3.4

ferry

The class took a **ferry** to Liberty Island. A **ferry** is —

- ☐ **A.** a boat that carries people across a river or waterway.
- ☐ **B.** a bridge made of stone.
- ☐ **C.** a train that runs underground.
- ☐ **D.** a tall tower by the sea.

Q18 L.3.4

monument

The Statue of Liberty is a famous **monument**. A **monument** is —

- ☐ **A.** a short note left for a friend.
- ☐ **B.** a small boat used for fishing.
- ☐ **C.** a large statue or building that honors an important person or event.
- ☐ **D.** a day off from school.

Q19 L.3.4

inspired

Emma Lazarus's poem **inspired** people to give money. If an idea **inspired** you, it —

- ☐ **A.** made you feel sleepy.
- ☐ **B.** made you want to do something.
- ☐ **C.** made you want to leave.
- ☐ **D.** made you forget what you knew.

Q20

L.3.5

TRAP

torch

The Statue of Liberty holds up a golden **torch**. A **torch** is —

- ☐ **A.** a window high on a wall.
- ☐ **B.** a heavy crown of metal.
- ☐ **C.** a flat stone tablet.
- ☐ **D.** a long stick with a flame at one end, used for light.

Q21

L.3.4

sculptor

A **sculptor** designed the Statue of Liberty. A **sculptor** is —

- ☐ **A.** an artist who uses clay, stone, wood, or metal to make a work of art.
- ☐ **B.** a captain who steers a ship.
- ☐ **C.** a ranger who guides visitors.
- ☐ **D.** a writer who makes up poems.



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 3 · Let Freedom Ring! · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.3.1 · RI.3.2 · RI.3.3 · RI.3.5 · RI.3.6 · RI.3.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · The U.S. Constitution

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · NORMAN PEARL / MATTHEW SKEENS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.3.2

According to the selection, what is the U.S. Constitution?

- ☐ A. A song that Americans sing on holidays.
- ☐ B. A list of the names of every state.
- ☐ C. The plan for how the government works and the highest law in the country.
- ☐ D. A map of the city of Philadelphia.

Q2 RI.3.6

Who tells the story of the Constitution, and why does the author choose him?

- ☐ A. James Madison, because he played a big part in writing the Constitution.
- ☐ B. A young student visiting Philadelphia today.
- ☐ C. A soldier from the navy.
- ☐ D. A park ranger on an island.

Q3 RI.3.3

Why did delegates meet in Philadelphia in 1787?

- ☐ A. To celebrate the end of a holiday.
- ☐ B. To choose a new flag for the navy.
- ☐ C. To build the city of Washington, D.C.
- ☐ D. To write the Constitution, a new set of rules for the country's government.

Q4 RI.3.2

What are the three main parts of the Constitution?

- ☐ **A.** The House, the Senate, and the courts.
- ☐ **B.** The preamble, the articles, and the amendments.
- ☐ **C.** The states, the cities, and the towns.
- ☐ **D.** The flag, the seal, and the anthem.

Q5 RI.3.3

The articles divide the U.S. government into three branches. Why does the selection say "no one branch can become stronger than the others"?

- ☐ **A.** To keep a "balance of power" so that every branch is equal.
- ☐ **B.** Because the branches are in three different countries.
- ☐ **C.** Because only one branch is allowed to make laws.
- ☐ **D.** So that the president can rule alone.

Q6 RI.3.3 **TRAP**

Which branch of government makes the nation's laws?

- ☐ **A.** The Executive Branch, headquartered in the White House.
- ☐ **B.** The Bill of Rights.
- ☐ **C.** The Judicial Branch, headquartered in the Supreme Court.
- ☐ **D.** The Legislative Branch — the Congress — headquartered in the Capitol.

Q7 RI.3.5 **TRAP**

The author organizes the early section of the selection by telling events in the order they happened, using dates. This text structure is called —

- ☐ **A.** compare and contrast.
- ☐ **B.** chronology, or time order.
- ☐ **C.** question and answer.
- ☐ **D.** cause and effect.

Q8 RI.3.8 **TRAP**

The selection says, "The Constitution is a symbol of democracy." What does this tell the reader about the United States?

- ☐ **A.** The Constitution can never be changed.
- ☐ **B.** Only one person makes all the rules.
- ☐ **C.** The government is run by the people, who choose their leaders by voting.
- ☐ **D.** The Constitution is just a list of dates.

Selection 2 · Why We Celebrate the Fourth of July

MEDIA: INFORMATIONAL VIDEO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.3.2

What happened on July 4, 1776?

- ☐ **A.** The Statue of Liberty opened to visitors.
- ☐ **B.** The Declaration of Independence was officially adopted.
- ☐ **C.** The Constitution was signed.
- ☐ **D.** The first flag was sewn in Baltimore.

Q10 RI.3.3

Why was the Declaration of Independence written?

- ☐ **A.** To plan a new city for the government.
- ☐ **B.** To build a fort to guard the harbor.
- ☐ **C.** To choose the colors of the flag.
- ☐ **D.** To declare the colonies' official independence from British rule.

Q11 RI.3.2

In the Declaration of Independence, "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" are —

- ☐ **A.** rights that belong to the people.
- ☐ **B.** three rules for the navy.
- ☐ **C.** the names of three colonies.
- ☐ **D.** three branches of government.

Q12 RI.3.3

Why is the Fourth of July sometimes called "America's birthday"?

- ☐ **A.** Because it is the warmest day of the year.
- ☐ **B.** Because the Statue of Liberty was built that day.
- ☐ **C.** Because July 4 is the day the colonies said they were free from Great Britain.
- ☐ **D.** Because the president has a party.

Q13 RI.3.8

In the video, what do images of the flag and the first American soldiers help show?

- ☐ **A.** The way a ferry crosses the water.
- ☐ **B.** How to sew a flag by hand.
- ☐ **C.** A feeling of pride in the United States.
- ☐ **D.** The 377 steps inside a statue.

Q14 RI.3.8

The video plays patriotic songs that are often heard on the Fourth of July. Producers add this music to —

- ☐ **A.** add to the feeling of pride, or patriotism.
- ☐ **B.** tell the viewer the exact date.
- ☐ **C.** make the video shorter.
- ☐ **D.** hide the pictures on the screen.

Q15 RI.3.5 TRAP

How is an informational VIDEO different from a printed informational text like "The U.S. Constitution"?

- ☐ **A.** A video can never give facts about a topic.
- ☐ **B.** A video must always be about animals.
- ☐ **C.** A video has no facts and only tells made-up stories.
- ☐ **D.** A video uses moving pictures, a narrator's voice, music, and sound to give information.

Q16 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "Why We Celebrate the Fourth of July"?

- ☐ **A.** The Fourth of July is only about fireworks and food.
- ☐ **B.** The Fourth of July celebrates the day the colonies declared their independence and the nation's ideals of liberty.
- ☐ **C.** The Fourth of July has nothing to do with freedom.
- ☐ **D.** The holiday celebrates the day the Constitution was signed.

Selection 3 · The Flag Maker

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · SUSAN CAMPBELL BARTOLETTI / CLAIRE A. NIVOLA · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.3.3

Who is Caroline Pickersgill, and what does her family do in Baltimore?

- ☐ **A.** A soldier who fights at sea.
- ☐ **B.** A park ranger who guides visitors.
- ☐ **C.** A delegate who signs the Constitution.
- ☐ **D.** A twelve-year-old girl whose family makes flags.

Q18 RI.3.3

Why did the military officers order such a large flag for Fort McHenry?

- ☐ **A.** So that it would be easy to fold.
- ☐ **B.** So that the British would have no trouble seeing it from a distance.
- ☐ **C.** So that it could be sent to France.
- ☐ **D.** So that it would fit on a small boat.

Q19 RI.3.3

The selection repeats the words "stitch after stitch, red stripe after white stripe, star after star." What does this repetition help show?

- ☐ **A.** How long and hard Caroline and her family worked to make the flag.
- ☐ **B.** That the work was finished in one hour.
- ☐ **C.** That the flag was very small.
- ☐ **D.** That no one wanted to help.

Q20 RI.3.3

What does Caroline see at dawn, after the long night of the British attack?

- ☐ **A.** The British ships sailing into the harbor.
- ☐ **B.** A brand-new flag being sewn.
- ☐ **C.** Her flag still hoisted high above the fort.
- ☐ **D.** The fort empty and dark.

Q21 RI.3.3

Why did the flag makers sew flags during the War of 1812? Give ONE reason from the selection.

- ☐ **A.** So that children would have something to play with.
- ☐ **B.** So that navy ships could communicate with each other during battles at sea.
- ☐ **C.** So that France would send a gift in return.
- ☐ **D.** So that the colonies could vote for leaders.

Q22 RI.3.6 TRAP

"The Flag Maker" is NARRATIVE NONFICTION. What does that tell the reader about the selection?

- ☐ **A.** It is a made-up tale about a talking flag.
- ☐ **B.** It is a poem written by James Madison.
- ☐ **C.** It is a list of rules with no story.
- ☐ **D.** It gives factual information by telling a true story about real people and events.

Q23 RI.3.3

Old-fashioned clothing, women sewing by hand, and a quill pen on the desk are details in the pictures. What do these details help show?

- ☐ **A.** That the story takes place in a busy modern city.
- ☐ **B.** That the story happens on a ship at sea.
- ☐ **C.** That the story takes place long ago, around the year 1812.
- ☐ **D.** That the story happens in France.

Q24 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA, or message, of "The Flag Maker"?

- ☐ **A.** Made with hard work, pride, courage, and hope, the flag becomes a powerful symbol of a nation that stands firm.
- ☐ **B.** A flag is only a piece of cloth and means nothing.
- ☐ **C.** The British won the battle at Fort McHenry.
- ☐ **D.** Sewing is the most boring kind of work.

Selection 4 · Why Is the Statue of Liberty Green?

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · MARTHA E. H. RUSTAD / HOLLI CONGER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RI.3.3

How do the students travel to the Statue of Liberty, and who teaches them about it?

- ☐ **A.** They ride a train, and James Madison teaches them.
- ☐ **B.** They take a ferry to Liberty Island, where Ranger Alisha teaches them.
- ☐ **C.** They fly in a plane, and a sculptor teaches them.
- ☐ **D.** They sail to France, and a soldier teaches them.

Q26 RI.3.3

Where did the Statue of Liberty come from?

- ☐ **A.** It was built in Baltimore during a war.
- ☐ **B.** It was found on Ellis Island.
- ☐ **C.** It was ordered by the delegates in Philadelphia.
- ☐ **D.** It was a gift from France to the United States, a symbol of friendship.

Q27 RI.3.3

According to Ranger Alisha, why is the Statue of Liberty green today?

- ☐ **A.** It was painted green when it was new.
- ☐ **B.** It is made of green glass.
- ☐ **C.** It was coppery brown when new, and rain, wind, and sun slowly changed the color to green.
- ☐ **D.** The torch lights it with a green flame.

Q28 RI.3.2

The statue's tablet reads "July IV MDCCLXXVI." What does this date stand for?

- ☐ **A.** July 4, 1776 — the day of American independence.
- ☐ **B.** The day France sent the gift.
- ☐ **C.** The number of steps to the crown.
- ☐ **D.** The day the statue turned green.

Q29 RI.3.3

Ranger Alisha says the steel frame inside the statue is "kind of like Lady Liberty's bones." What does the frame do?

- ☐ **A.** It lights the torch at night.
- ☐ **B.** It changes the color of the copper.
- ☐ **C.** It carries visitors across the water.
- ☐ **D.** It holds the statue up and keeps it standing.

Q30 RI.3.3

Why was the Statue of Liberty important to people who sailed to the United States past Ellis Island?

- ☐ **A.** It was one of the first things they saw, seeming to welcome them to their new home.
- ☐ **B.** It told them the time of day.
- ☐ **C.** It sold them tickets for the crown.
- ☐ **D.** It carried their boxes to New York.

Q31 RI.3.6 TRAP

"Why Is the Statue of Liberty Green?" tells facts by following a class on a field trip. How does the reader learn the information?

- ☐ **A.** From a list of dates with no people.
- ☐ **B.** From James Madison telling the story.
- ☐ **C.** Through the students' questions and Ranger Alisha's answers during the tour.
- ☐ **D.** From a song the class sings on the ferry.

Q32

RI.3.2

TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "Why Is the Statue of Liberty Green?"

- ☐ **A.** The statue is only interesting because it is tall.
- ☐ **B.** A national monument like the Statue of Liberty can be a powerful symbol of freedom and welcome.
- ☐ **C.** Copper should never be left out in the rain.
- ☐ **D.** Field trips are the best part of school.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 3 · Let Freedom Ring! · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how historic places, documents, and symbols represent the United States. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Systems DOK 3

In "**The U.S. Constitution**," the government is divided into THREE branches so that no one branch can grow too strong. Show what each branch does, then explain the "balance of power."

THREE BRANCHES · ONE BALANCE OF POWER

LEGISLATIVE · CONGRESS

EXECUTIVE · PRESIDENT

JUDICIAL · COURTS

Why is it important that all three branches stay EQUAL? Use the words "balance of power."

This module is full of words about what Americans VALUE. Show THREE ideals from the selections and where each one appears.

THREE AMERICAN IDEALS

FREEDOM / LIBERTY ·
STATUE OF LIBERTY

INDEPENDENCE · FOURTH
OF JULY

DEMOCRACY · THE
CONSTITUTION

Which ideal feels MOST important to you? Why?

Q3

Change over Time

DOK 3

In "**Why Is the Statue of Liberty Green?**" the statue did not always look the way it does now. Map the CHANGE from new to green.

CHANGE OVER TIME · FROM BROWN TO GREEN

The Statue
Changes

WHEN NEW · WHAT COLOR WAS IT?

WHAT CAUSED THE CHANGE? (RAIN, WIND,
SUN)

WHAT COLOR IS IT NOW?

WHAT STAYS THE SAME — WHAT IT STANDS
FOR?

Even though its color changed, what about the statue has NOT changed? Explain.

Q4

Identity

DOK 3

In "**The Flag Maker**," a girl and her family sew a giant flag that survives a battle. Trace THREE steps that turn the flag into a symbol of the nation.

THREE STEPS · FROM CLOTH TO SYMBOL

STEP 1 · THE ORDER

why do the officers want such a large flag?

STEP 2 · THE WORK

how do Caroline and her family make it?

STEP 3 · THE DAWN

what does Caroline see after the attack?

Why does the flag come to stand for pride, courage, and hope?

Essential Question: How do historic places, documents, and symbols represent the United States? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What place, document, or symbol does it show — and what does it represent?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What place, document, or symbol does it show — and what does it represent?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 3 · Let Freedom Ring! · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Liberty Bell

In the city of Philadelphia hangs a famous old bell. It is called the Liberty Bell. Long ago, the bell rang to call people together for important news. It rang for meetings and for special days. The bell is large and made of metal. Across the top are written the words "Proclaim Liberty." Liberty is another word for freedom. One day, after many years of ringing, a crack appeared in the side of the bell. The crack grew longer, and the bell could no longer ring. Today the Liberty Bell does not make a sound. But people still come from all over to see it. They look at the crack and read the word "Liberty." The bell reminds them of the freedom that Americans share. A bell that can no longer ring still has a strong voice. It speaks of liberty without making a sound.

152 WORDS · LEXILE 420–470L · RIT 195–201

Q1

RIT 195

Lexile 420L

Key Detail

Where does the Liberty Bell hang?

- ☐ **A.** Inside a school.
- ☐ **B.** On a ship at sea.
- ☐ **C.** In the city of Philadelphia.
- ☐ **D.** On top of a mountain.

Q2

RIT 197

Lexile 430L

Cause & Effect

Why can the Liberty Bell no longer ring?

- ☐ **A.** Because a crack appeared and grew longer in its side.
- ☐ **B.** Because it was melted down.
- ☐ **C.** Because no one is allowed to touch it.
- ☐ **D.** Because it is too small to make a sound.

Q3

RIT 199

Lexile 450L

Inference

The passage says, "A bell that can no longer ring still has a strong voice." This MOST likely means the bell —

- ☐ **A.** rings louder than before.
- ☐ **B.** can talk to visitors.
- ☐ **C.** is about to be fixed.
- ☐ **D.** still stands for an important idea — freedom — even in silence.

Q4 RIT 200 Lexile 460L Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **liberty** most nearly means —

- ☐ A. a kind of bell.
- ☐ B. freedom.
- ☐ C. a crack in metal.
- ☐ D. a large city.

Q5 RIT 201 Lexile 470L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Liberty Bell"?

- ☐ A. A cracked old bell still stands as a powerful symbol of freedom.
- ☐ B. Bells should be kept in museums.
- ☐ C. Philadelphia is the largest city in America.
- ☐ D. Metal cracks easily over time.

Passage 2 · The Bald Eagle

The bald eagle is a large bird with a white head and a brown body. It is found only in North America. Long ago, the leaders of the new United States needed a symbol for their country. They wanted an animal that was strong and free. They chose the bald eagle. The eagle can fly very high and see far below. It builds huge nests at the tops of tall trees. For many years, the bald eagle was in danger, and there were very few left. People worked hard to protect the bird and its home. Laws were made to keep it safe. Slowly, the number of eagles grew. Today the bald eagle is no longer in danger. You can see the eagle on coins, on flags, and on the Great Seal of the United States. It reminds Americans to be strong and free, just like the bird itself.

154 WORDS · LEXILE 480–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 Lexile 480L Key Detail

What does a bald eagle look like?

- ☐ A. A small gray bird that cannot fly.
- ☐ B. A large bird with a white head and a brown body.
- ☐ C. A green bird that lives in the sea.
- ☐ D. A bird with no feathers at all.

Q7 RIT 204 Lexile 490L Cause & Effect

Why did the leaders of the United States choose the bald eagle as a symbol?

- ☐ A. Because it was the only bird they could find.
- ☐ B. Because it could sing the loudest.
- ☐ C. Because it lived in their city.
- ☐ D. Because they wanted an animal that was strong and free.

Q8 RIT 205 Lexile 500L Inference

Why is the bald eagle "no longer in danger" today?

- ☐ A. Because people worked to protect the bird, and laws were made to keep it safe.
- ☐ B. Because they moved to another country.
- ☐ C. Because people stopped looking for them.
- ☐ D. Because eagles stopped building nests.

Q9 RIT 206 Lexile 510L Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **symbol** most nearly means —

- ☐ A. a coin made of gold.
- ☐ B. a kind of large nest.
- ☐ C. something that stands for an idea or a country.
- ☐ D. a tall tree.

Q10 RIT 207 Lexile 530L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Bald Eagle"?

- ☐ A. Eagles build the biggest nests of any bird.
- ☐ B. The bald eagle was chosen as a symbol of a strong, free country and was saved by people who cared.
- ☐ C. Coins are the best place to put a bird.
- ☐ D. North America has many kinds of birds.

Passage 3 · Mount Rushmore

High in the hills of South Dakota, four giant faces look out from a mountain. This is Mount Rushmore. The faces are carved into solid rock. They show four men who were once presidents of the United States: George Washington, Thomas Jefferson, Theodore Roosevelt, and Abraham Lincoln. Each face is taller than a five-story building. A sculptor named Gutzon Borglum led the work. Hundreds of workers helped him. They used tools to cut and shape the hard stone. The work was difficult and even dangerous. It took fourteen years to finish. Why did they carve the faces so large? They wanted to honor leaders who helped build and hold together the country. Visitors come from all over the world to stand below the great stone faces and look up. The four presidents seem to watch over the land. Mount Rushmore is a monument that turns a mountain into a symbol of the nation's history.

155 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 Lexile 540L Key Detail

What is carved into the mountain at Mount Rushmore?

- ☐ A. Four giant birds.
- ☐ B. The words of the Constitution.
- ☐ C. A large bell.
- ☐ D. The faces of four men who were once presidents.

Q12 RIT 209 Lexile 560L Cause & Effect

Why did the workers carve the faces so large?

- ☐ A. They wanted to hide the mountain.
- ☐ B. They wanted to honor leaders who helped build and hold together the country.
- ☐ C. They needed a place to keep their tools.
- ☐ D. They were copying the Statue of Liberty.

Q13 RIT 210 Lexile 570L Inference

The passage says the work "was difficult and even dangerous" and "took fourteen years to finish." This helps the reader understand that —

- ☐ A. the workers gave up quickly.
- ☐ B. the faces were easy to carve.
- ☐ C. building the monument took great effort and time.
- ☐ D. the mountain was made of soft sand.

Q14 RIT 211 Lexile 580L Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **monument** most nearly means —

- ☐ A. a large structure that honors important people or events.
- ☐ B. a five-story building.
- ☐ C. a tool used to cut stone.
- ☐ D. a hill in South Dakota.

Q15 RIT 212 Lexile 600L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Mount Rushmore"?

- ☐ A. South Dakota has the tallest hills in America.
- ☐ B. Carving rock is the hardest job in the world.
- ☐ C. Mount Rushmore turns a mountain into a monument that honors the nation's history.
- ☐ D. Visitors should not look up at the faces.

Passage 4 · The National Anthem

Every country has a special song called a national anthem. The anthem of the United States is "The Star-Spangled Banner." It is sung before games and on important days. But where did the song come from? More than two hundred years ago, the United States was at war. One night, British ships fired on an American fort for hours. A man named Francis Scott Key watched from a ship far away. He was afraid the fort would fall. All night he waited in the dark. When morning came, Key looked toward the fort. There, in the early light, he saw the American flag still waving. The fort had held. Filled with joy and relief, Key wrote a poem about the flag he saw. Later, his words were set to music. That poem became the national anthem. So when Americans sing "The Star-Spangled Banner," they are remembering a flag that stood firm through a long, dark night.

Q16 RIT 213 Lexile 610L Key Detail

What is the national anthem of the United States?

- ☐ A. "The Star-Spangled Banner."
- ☐ B. "Proclaim Liberty."
- ☐ C. "Our Flag."
- ☐ D. "America's Birthday."

Q17 RIT 214 Lexile 630L Cause & Effect

Why was Francis Scott Key afraid during the night?

- ☐ A. Because he had lost his way home.
- ☐ B. Because he could not write his poem.
- ☐ C. Because British ships were firing on the American fort, and he feared it would fall.
- ☐ D. Because the game had not started.

Q18 RIT 214 Lexile 650L Inference

Why was Key "filled with joy and relief" in the morning?

- ☐ A. Because the war was finally over forever.
- ☐ B. Because he saw the American flag still waving, which meant the fort had held.
- ☐ C. Because he had won a prize for his poem.
- ☐ D. Because he was about to sing at a game.

Q19 RIT 215 Lexile 670L Vocabulary

The passage says the fort "had held." Here, **held** most nearly means —

- ☐ A. picked something up in two hands.
- ☐ B. kept a tight grip on a rope.
- ☐ C. waited quietly in the dark.
- ☐ D. stayed strong and did not fall.

Q20 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The National Anthem"?

- ☐ A. Anthems should only be sung before games.
- ☐ B. Francis Scott Key was the best poet in America.
- ☐ C. Wars always end in the morning.
- ☐ D. The national anthem began as a poem about a flag that stood firm, and it still honors that moment.